

Category:

Economic & Financial Systems



Topic #1: Recessions, Credit, and the Financial System

1. **Create a short presentation (1-3 minutes) on one of the following topics:**
 - a. During recessions and depressions, borrowing slows and financial risk increases. How should an investment firm decide whether to invest in loans (such as mortgages, auto loans, or student loans) when the economy is weakening? **OR**
 - b. Explain how firms balance risk, stability, and return during downturns and what signals they watch when deciding where to invest.
2. **Design a sample loan investment portfolio for a recession scenario. (2-4 Minutes)**
 - a. Choose two of the below loan types and decide which might perform better or worse during an economic downturn.
 - i. Auto loans
 - ii. Student loans
 - iii. Credit cards
 - b. From the two chosen, explain which of the assets feel safer, which are riskier, and why investors may shift strategies during recessions.
3. **Create an infographic explaining how everyday loan payments continue to flow through the financial system during recessions and depressions and how a specific community can be affected by it. (2-3 Minutes)**
 - a. Must Select one of the following loan payments types: car loans, student loans, or credit cards
 - b. Show how these payments become investments for financial firms and why changes in employment, spending, and repayment rates matter during economic downturns.

Topic #2: Investment Banks & the Capital Markets

1. Create a 5-slide presentation (3-4 minutes) on one of the following topics:

- a. What are capital markets, and how do they help businesses grow and create jobs? Who are the key players: like companies, investment banks, and investors and what roles do they each play?
- b. Find a real company that used an investment bank to raise money through an IPO (Initial Public Offering), bond offering, or other financing deal. Look for press releases and investor presentations on the company's investor relations section of their website. Summarize the following:
 - What type of financing the company used
 - Why the company needed the money
 - Which investment bank(s) helped them
 - What key selling points were used to market the deal to investors (i.e. how did investor materials market this as a good investment?)

2. Create a (2-3 minutes) mini documentary that shows how different teams at an investment bank work together to launch an IPO. Focus on the following teams and their roles:

- Investment Banking: Helps the company go public, sets the price for shares, and creates marketing materials like the pitch book and roadshow presentations to attract investors.
- Sales & Trading: Sells shares to investors and ensures demand for the IPO.
- Research: Analyzes the company and gives recommendations to potential investors.
- Risk Management: Assesses risks and ensures the IPO is secure for the bank and investors.
- Operations/Compliance: Manages the legal and regulatory process to ensure the IPO is compliant.

3. Simulate Your Own IPO (2-3 Minutes)

- **Design a fictional company profile:**
 - What's your company name?
 - What industry is it in?
 - What product or service does it offer?
 - What makes it unique or innovative?
 - Who are the main competitors?

- **Create a mini pitch deck:** Design 2–3 slides that will promote your company to potential investors. Explain why your company is ready to go public and how you will use the money raised.

Topic #3: Fintech – Revolutionizing Finance

- 1. Create a 5-slide presentation (1- 3.5 minutes) select one of the following topics:**
 - a. What is fintech, and how has it changed traditional banking and finance?
 - b. How fintech is improving financial inclusion. What role do mobile banking apps, digital wallets, or micro-loans play in providing financial services to underserved communities? Provide examples of fintech products that are improving financial inclusion.
- 2. Create a short infographic presentation (2-3 slides) (1-3.5 minutes)**
 - a. Explains key fintech trends, such as mobile payments, blockchain, robo-advisors, or peer-to-peer lending.
 - b. Include statistics on how these trends are changing the financial landscape.
- 3. Choose a fintech company (e.g., PayPal, Square, Robinhood) and research its services. (1-3.5 minutes)**
 - What problem does the company solve?
 - What technologies or business models does it use?
 - How has it impacted consumers, businesses, or the economy?
 - Create a 1-2 minute video or a visual report (charts/slides) summarizing the company's mission, products, and impact.

Topic #4: Housing Finance & Structured Credit

- 1. Create a short presentation (3-5 minutes) on the following topic:**
 - a. Explain how factors like interest rates, home prices, borrower risk, and housing demand influence investment decisions in mortgage and housing markets.
- 2. Create a mini-documentary (1-3 minutes) explaining how housing finance supports homeowners and the broader economy.**
 - a. Show how home loans help people buy homes, how lenders provide financing, and how investors support housing markets. Must Include:
 - i. how mortgages help people buy homes
 - ii. Select a county and explain how housing affects families and the neighborhoods within it
 - iii. how lenders and investors support the housing system

Media Formats: interviews, visuals, or data showing how housing credit affects communities and long-term financial stability.

- 3. Create an infographic (2-3 Slides explaining how home loans become investment products.) Must Include:**
 - i. Show how a mortgage moves from:homebuyer → lender → investors
 - ii. How monthly mortgage payments become income for financial firms?
 - iii. Why does housing finance play an important role in the overall economy?